Letter monetization v2 (prompt 54 §3), 2 Nov 2026

One letter for everyone, every Tuesday and Friday, in PT, EN and FR (D74), in the voice of content/VOICE_AND_WORLD.md (D73). This plan applies sponsors/NEWSLETTER_PLAYBOOK.md to it.

The prices start from the CEO's numbers in prompt 53 §5. Where the research argues for a change, the change is marked **proposal**. **All prices are for the CEO to approve** (CLAUDE.md, How to work 5; task 45b). Letter products only: the per-building developer placement (D63), the partner agency's sponsorship and social extensions are priced separately in RATE_CARD_v5.

1. Inventory

- 104 letters a year, about 8.7 a month.
- **Each letter carries one sponsor element**, plus the Friday weekend item.
- **Per month:**
  - one block on every letter, sold by the letter or by the month, exclusive by category;
  - one "Apresentado por" (the month's title sponsor);
  - at most one sponsored story;
  - up to four Friday weekend items.
- **Per year:** four to six themed series of six letters each, and the Portugal 100 reveal (late November).

2. Products and prices by stage

Prices are per unit. The Founding Partner offer gives the first ten sponsors −40% in year 1 and keeps the price in year 2 (CLAUDE.md).

Product	What the sponsor gets	Months 1–6 (under 5,000 subscribers)	Months 7–12 (5,000–10,000)	Year 2 (10,000 and more)
Partner block	100–150 words and a logo, written by us in the letter's voice, approved by the sponsor for facts; one per letter; exclusive by category	250 € per letter; **1,500 € a month**	**proposal:** 50 € per 1,000 subscribers per letter (5,000 → 250 €, 8,000 → 400 €); a month = 6 letters' price	60 € per 1,000 subscribers per letter (10,000 → 600 €), reviewed every quarter
Apresentado por	The month's header line, the block on every letter, and one destaque on its theme; all labelled	**4,000 € a month**	**proposal:** 2.5 × the month of blocks (8,000 → 6,000 €)	2.5 × the month of blocks (10,000 → 9,000 €)
Series of six letters	A theme on six letters (the Algarve golf weeks, the Douro harvest), bought as a calendar	2,500 €	10 × the per-letter block (8,000 → 4,000 €)	the same rule
Friday weekend item	A table, a hotel or an event, 60–80 words and a photo, labelled	**proposal: 300 €** (CEO 400 €; short units sell at about ¼ of a native ad, Oshinsky)	1.2 × the per-letter block	the same rule
The sponsored story ("A história, apresentada por")	A whole destaque about the bigger subject the sponsor belongs to (a bank → how non-residents borrow), written by us under a published selection test (Not Boring); from month 4, at most one a month	1,500 €	6 × the per-letter block	the same rule
Events	§4	from month 6	1 or 2	3 to 4 a year
Portugal 100 presenting sponsor	The yearly reveal, the printed object and the event; never the ranking (D69)	—	**proposal:** 12,000–20,000 €, sold from September 2027	the same, plus the licence (§5)

Rules for the prices:

- **Thresholds.** A price changes on the first day of the quarter after the list passes a threshold, using the confirmed subscribers on the operator's report.
- **Raises.** When the next quarter is 80% booked, raise prices and open a waiting list; never add a second sponsor element.
- **No discounts.** Give inventory instead: an extra Friday item, a social post.
- **Minimum.** Three months, with the step-up written into the first contract.
- **Exclusivity.** By category, per letter and per month, at +50% for a whole quarter.

For the CEO (task 54a):

1. "Apresentado por" at 4,000 € a month is about 48,000 € a year. That is 4 to 6 times the Gold package in CLAUDE.md (8–12k € a year), so the two need one ladder. Proposal: Gold = 6 "Apresentado por" months or 12 block-months, Silver = 3 block-months, Bronze = one series.
2. At 1,000 subscribers no benchmark supports 250 € per letter: it works out to about 556 € per 1,000 opens, against $15–75 in the market (playbook §3). It sells only as a Founding Partnership: the brand next to the index and the Portugal 100, the price locked, the monthly report. The media kit shows a price per 1,000 subscribers only from 5,000.
3. Paid recommendations (beehiiv Boosts, SparkLoop) pay per subscriber. Is that "per lead" under D6? Proposal: we don't sell them. We may buy them for growth once a sponsor has paid.

3. The quality rules we adopt

1. **One sponsor element per letter.** On Fridays, the weekend item may be a second one, and is labelled the same way. Never a dedicated sponsor send.
2. **The label cannot be missed.** "Patrocinado", "Apresentado por {brand}", "A história, apresentada por {brand}" (Código da Publicidade art. 8, hard rule 4), in the same type as the letter, at the top of the element.
3. **We write it, they approve the facts.** Our writers draft every sponsor element in the letter's voice (Morning Brew). The sponsor checks names, numbers and its offer, never our editorial.
4. **The right to refuse, with a written test** (Not Boring):
   - Would we write about this company unpaid?
   - Is it useful to someone buying or living in Portugal from abroad?
   - Is its offer legal and plain, with no "guaranteed returns"?

   We publish the test and refuse what fails it.
5. **Never sold:**
   - per lead or per click (D6);
   - any real-estate agency other than the partner (D9);
   - the index score or a Portugal 100 place (D69);
   - paid entry into any ranking or award (the 2008 Wine Spectator lesson);
   - a sponsor's sight of editorial before it is published, except its own element.
6. **Category caps** (FT HTSI): at most two sponsors from one category in a month, and no more than five campaigns live at once.
7. **Every sponsor gets the monthly report** (prompt 51): reach, clicks, readers by country, requests and the advisor's reply time, the same figures on their private page. The report is what renews (playbook §4).

4. Events and experiences

Small, editor-hosted rooms, one presenting sponsor each, never a pay-to-play panel (TRD). Monocle sold about 200 seats at $2,600 in Lisbon in 2026, and its events grew 87% in 2025.

The costs below are **our estimates**; none were quoted by a supplier, and every supplier is asked before a date is set.

Event	When	Who comes	Revenue	Costs (est.)	Margin (est.)
A dinner in the Douro at a quinta, with the winemaker; the next morning on the river	May or September (the harvest)	24: the sponsor's clients and readers chosen by ballot	Presenting sponsor (private bank or developer) 10,000 €	Dinner and wine about 150 € a head (3,600 €), transport from Porto 800 €, photography 500 €, sundries 600 €	about 4,500 €
A golf day in the Algarve with a partner resort	February–April (the golf weeks) or October	40 players: readers pay 120 € (lunch), the resort gives the course as its sponsorship	Title sponsor (FX firm, insurer or bank) 8,000 € + 4,800 € tickets	Green fees at the group rate and lunch, about 6,000 €; prizes and printing 800 €	about 6,000 €
A Lisbon art walk with a partner bank: three galleries and a studio	October (ARCOlisboa is in May)	20	Partner bank 5,000 €	Guide, drinks and a car, about 1,200 €	about 3,800 €
The Portugal 100 evening in Lisbon	late November 2027	80–120	Presenting sponsor 12,000–20,000 € (§2)	Venue and dinner, about 120 € a head	depends on the venue

Rules:

- The letter tells the story of the event; it never sells seats to readers as an advertisement.
- The guest list stays with us: no list goes to the sponsor (hard rule 3).
- The partner agency's advisor attends as a guest, never as a seller on stage.

5. Year 2 and later

- **A paid tier from 20,000 subscribers.** Puck charges $100/$250 and Lenny $200–400 (playbook §4). Ours would be the Portugal 100 dossier, the guides and two dinners a year.
- **A licence to use a published index result** in the licensee's own marketing (Shanken: $1,000/yr per brand). Only once the CEO and a lawyer agree: municipalities and developers are both subjects and buyers.
- **Products made with partners:** a Douro wine bottled for the Portugal 100, a printed guide. Never inventory (Hodinkee).

6. Three scenarios for 12 months (Dec 2026 to Nov 2027)

Computed by sponsors/build/letter_scenarios.py. Letter products only, at the prices above. The Founding −40% applies to the first ten sponsors. Event figures are the estimated margins in §4.

Scenario	Subscribers in Nov 2027	Letter revenue, list prices	After the Founding discount, plus event margin	Months 1–6 (list)	Months 7–12 (list)	Per subscriber (Nov 2027)
Conservative	6,000	35,762 €	**21,457 €**	13,950 €	21,812 €	3.6 €
Base	10,000	116,302 €	**94,737 €**	40,703 €	75,599 €	9.5 €
Ambitious	25,000	300,896 €	**280,753 €**	91,664 €	209,232 €	11.2 €

Assumptions, written out:

- **Conservative.**
  - Subscribers: 800 by the end of December, 3,000 by May, 6,000 by November. This is below the PLAN target of 5,000 by 24 Jan.
  - Blocks: 25% of block-months sold in months 1–6, 40% after.
  - Other sales: four "Apresentado por" months, two series, Friday items from month 3, two sponsored stories, no events.
  - All sponsors at the Founding price.
- **Base.**
  - Subscribers: 5,000 by March and 10,000 by November.
  - Blocks: 40% sold in months 1–3, 60% in months 4–6, 75% after.
  - Other sales: ten "Apresentado por" months, four series, three or four Friday items a month, five sponsored stories, a Douro dinner (May) and a golf day (October).
  - 70% of revenue at the Founding price.
- **Ambitious.**
  - Subscribers: 5,000 by January, 10,000 by May, 25,000 by November.
  - Blocks: 60% sold, then 90% from month 4.
  - Other sales: nine "Apresentado por" months, six series, four or five Friday items, ten sponsored stories, four events.
  - 40% of revenue at the Founding price.

What the numbers say:

- **The base case** earns about 9.5 € per subscriber in a year. That is above Morning Brew, The Hustle and 1440 at about 5–7 € (D, playbook §3), because a premium niche sells higher units. It needs the base sell-through to hold.
- **The conservative case** is below one Gold sponsor a month. It still covers the year's costs (domains and free tools, hard rule 5).
- **The ambitious case** depends on per-reader prices holding at the premium end: about 133 € per 1,000 opens at 45% opens. If the market prices us as an ordinary niche ($30–75), the year 2 figures halve.

The levers, in order:

1. sell-through of the blocks (a calendar sold in advance);
2. the "Apresentado por" months to banks in December–January;
3. subscribers.

Could not verify

- Event costs: no supplier was asked, so these are estimates.
- The real open rate of our list before launch (45% is assumed in the playbook arithmetic).
- Whether beehiiv's free plan allows the API that would report opens automatically (ops/METRICS_SETUP.md).
- Any primary CPM benchmark for real-estate or luxury newsletters (playbook, Could not verify).